

426 *The Trial of the Seven Bishops.*

to the Act of the Government: The Government here has published such a Declaration as this, that has been read, relating to Matters of Government: And shall, or ought, any Body to come and impeach that as illegal which the Government has done? Truly, in my Opinion, I do not think he should, or ought; for by this Rule may every Act of the Government be shaken, when there is not a Parliament *de Facto* sitting.

I do agree, That every Man may petition the Government, or the King, in a Matter that relates to his own private Interest; but to meddle with a Matter that relates to the Government, I do not think my Lords the Bishops had any Power to do more than any others: When the House of Lords and Commons are in being, it is a proper way of applying to the King, there is all the openness in the World, for those that are Members of Parliament, to make what Addresses they please to the Government, for the rectifying, altering, regulating, and making of what Law they please; but if every private Man shall come and interpose his Advice, I think, there can never be an end of advising the Government: I think there was an Instance of this in King *James's* Time, when, by a solemn Resolution, it was declared to be a High Misdemeanor, and next to Treason, to petition the King to put the Penal Laws in Execution.

Mr. Just. Powel. Brother, I think you do mistake a little.

Mr. Just. Allybone. Brother, I dare rely upon
on